come-from-arunachal-pradesh-madhavpur-mela-guajat-vijay-rupani-mahesh-sharma-5116300/.

8. P.N. Luthra, 'North-East Frontier Agency tribes: Impact of Ahom and British policy', *Economic & Political Weekly*, Vol. 6, No. 23, 5 June 1971, p. 1144.
9. Ibid.
10. For more on the Sanskritisation theory, see M.N. Srinivas, *Religion and Society among the Coorgs of South India* (Oxford, UK: Oxford University Press, 1952).
11. The NEFA officer tasked with excavations was L.N. Chakravarty. M.L. Bose, *A History of Arunachal Pradesh* (New Delhi: Concept, 1997), pp. 41–43. In some versions of the Krishna–Rukmini story, she is depicted as a princess of Vidarbha in Maharashtra. The story is mentioned in the Udyog Parv of the Mahabharat, and the Bhagvat and Vishnu Puranas. Her father Bhishnak's capital in these versions is a village in Maharashtra. As Byomkesh Tripathy has pointed out, the Arunachal version of this tale transplanted the entire setting of Vidarbha to local habitations in the state. See Byomkesh Tripathy, S. Dutta (eds), *Religious History of Arunachal Pradesh* (New Delhi: Gyan, 2008).
12. See Special Correspondent, 'Arunachal Pradesh former chief minister Gegong Apang quits BJP', *The Hindu*, 16 January 2019, https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/other-states/arunachal-pradesh-former-chief-minister-gegong-apang-quits-bjp/article26004433.ece and https://www.rediff.com/news/2004/aug/28apang.htm.
13. In Assam, BJP's Sarbanand Sonowal headed the eighty-six-member coalition that took office in 2016: sixty BJP, fourteen Asom Gana Parishad (AGP,) twelve Bodoland People's Front (BPF) after winning a majority in the 126-member Assam assembly. Himanta Biswa Sarma, took office as the state's second BJP chief minister in 2021 as the head of a seventy-five member coalition majority: sixty BJP, nine AGP, six United People's Party Liberal (UPPL). In Manipur, the Congress was the single largest party with twenty-eight seats, but Nongthombam Biren Singh assumed power as part of a coalition of twenty-one BJP, four NPF, four NPP and one LJP MLAs, supported by some